UX REPORT – KHAN ACADEMY

GROUP: LATE TO THE PARTY

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IMY 320 GROUP DESIGN A

09 August 2026

1. Introduction

The site evaluated for this report is Khan Academy (khanacademy.org), a free online learning platform that offers video lessons, practice exercises and full courses across subjects such as maths, science and the humanities. It was selected as a reference point for our group's login/register redesign because it is a large, well established education platform that a lot of users would already be familiar with, which makes it useful for comparing against the more commercial platforms the rest of the group looked at, Coursera and Udemy. Khan Academy states its mission as providing a free, world-class education to anyone, anywhere (Khan Academy, n.d.).

Before designing our own login flow, we needed to understand how users already experience existing conventions, since our client wants a login and register system that feels familiar and reusable rather than something users must relearn. This evaluation is directly tied to the group's brief: before we dive into designing a flexible login-register component that aligns with Jakob's Law, we need to first grasp how well-established platforms like Khan Academy manage that flow (Nielsen, 2000).

2. Methodology

- We utilized a shortened version of the User Experience Questionnaire (UEQ-S), which was scored using a 7-point semantic differential scale (Schrepp, Hinderks and Thomaschewski, 2017).
- **Participants:**
  - We had 3 individuals per site, referred to as P1, P2, and P3 for anonymity in each group.
- **Pages evaluated:** Landing Page, Login Page, and About Us page
- **Procedure (the same for all three reports):**
  - Open the website
  - Spend about 2-3 minutes exploring the Landing page as well as the About Us page.
  - Navigate to the Login page.
  - Go back to the form and answer the questions
- **Scale:** 7-point semantic differential across 8 criteria:
  - Obstructive – Supportive
  - Complicated – Easy
  - Confusing – Clear
  - Boring – Exciting
  - Conventional – Innovative

- Usual – Modern
- Inefficient – Efficient
- Not Interesting – Interesting

3. Participant Overview

Participant	Age
P1	22
P2	21
P3	26

4. UEQ Results

4.1 Landing Page

Criterion	P1	P2	P3	Average
Obstructive-Supportive	5	5	5	5.0
Complicated-Easy	7	6	5	6.0
Confusing-Clear	7	7	4	6.0
Boring-Exciting	5	5	5	5.0
Conventional-Innovative	5	6	5	5.3
Usual-Modern	7	6	5	6.0
Inefficient-Efficient	6	7	4	5.7
Not Interesting-Interesting	5	7	5	5.7

4.2 Login Page

Criterion	P1	P2	P3	Average
Obstructive-Supportive	7	7	4	6.0
Complicated-Easy	7	7	5	6.3
Confusing-Clear	7	7	4	6.0
Boring-Exciting	5	6	4	5.0
Conventional-Innovative	5	6	6	5.7
Usual-Modern	6	6	5	5.7
Inefficient-Efficient	6	7	4	5.7

Not Interesting-Interesting	5	7	5	5.7

4.3 About Us Page

Criterion	P1	P2	P3	Average
Obstructive-Supportive	6	7	5	6.0
Complicated-Easy	6	7	4	5.7
Confusing-Clear	6	7	5	6.0
Boring-Exciting	5	6	6	5.7
Conventional-Innovative	5	6	4	5.0
Usual-Modern	7	6	5	6.0
Inefficient-Efficient	7	7	4	6.0
Not Interesting-Interesting	6	7	5	6.0

5. Findings

Highest-scoring criterion: Login page “Easy to Use” (6.3) was the single highest score across the whole evaluation, and “Clarity” and “Supportive” both reached 6.0 on the Login page as well as on the About Us page. Khan Academy's login form follows the standard email and password pattern seen on almost every major platform, with no unconventional field order or extra steps, which is most likely why participants found it so easy and clear to use.

Lowest-scoring criterion: “Conventional-Innovative” was the weakest or joint-weakest dimension on every page (5.3 on Landing, 5.7 on Login, 5.0 on About Us), and “Boring-Exciting” matched it at 5.0 on both the Landing and Login pages. Khan Academy plays it safe with its layout and login flow. Nothing about it surprises the user, which is great for usability but limits how novel or exciting it feels.

When considering **Jakob's Law**, this split tells a clear story. Users tend to rate a familiar, convention-following design as easy and clear, but that same familiarity means the design rarely feels new or exciting, because it is not trying to surprise anyone. This adherence to familiar design is exactly what Jakob's Law suggests will minimize friction (Nielsen, 2000; Wong, 2026), reducing the cognitive effort required to reconcile the interface with users' existing mental models (Norman, 1988).

One area worth noting is that Supportive scored comparatively low on the Landing page (5.0) compared to the Login and About Us pages (both 6.0). This suggests the landing page does not do quite as much as it could to guide a new visitor towards the next step, whether that's browsing a course or heading to the login page, even though the login page itself, once found, is rated as clear and supportive.

Looking specifically at the login and registration process, participants did not report unusual field requirements or extra friction. The form follows a familiar structure, which is likely the main reason Easy to Use and Clarity both scored highly on that page. This approach reduces friction and aligns with the “flexible/generic” quality the client wants to replicate across their other sites.

6. Design Guidelines Derived

To build a reusable, lightweight login solution adaptable to multiple sister sites, we take Jakob's Law (Nielsen, 2000; Wong, 2026) as the core guiding principle, and develop four design rules based on Khan Academy's platform data:

- Keep the login form structure familiar (email, password, clearly labelled buttons), since this is what drove Khan Academy's highest scores, and deviating from it risks lowering ease of use without a clear benefit.
- Don't chase “innovative” at the cost of clarity. Khan Academy's data shows these two can trade off against each other, so any creative flourishes in our design should sit around the familiar structure, not replace it.
- Strengthen the landing page's call to action toward login/register, since a slightly lower Supportive score there suggests users could be guided more clearly before they reach the login page.
- Where the brief calls for the login system to be reusable across sister sites, keep the core interaction pattern (field order, button placement, feedback on errors) identical between sites, and only vary branding, so returning users carry over the same mental model.

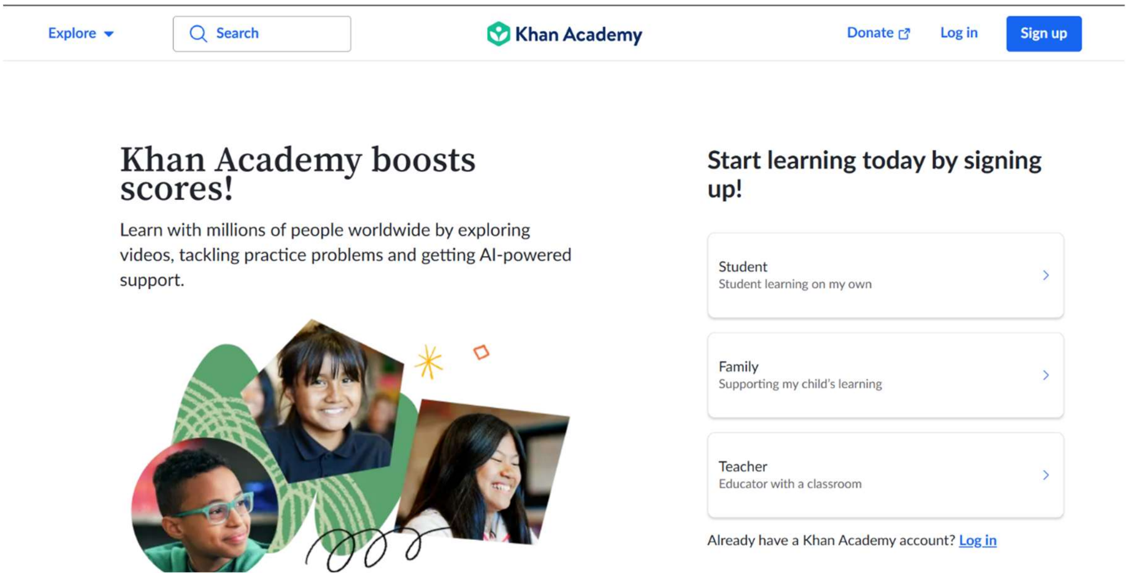
7. Conclusion

Evaluating Khan Academy showed that a design which sticks closely to familiar login and navigation conventions tends to score well on usability and clarity, even though it may come across as less exciting or innovative. This trade-off is a clear example of Jakob's Law in action (Nielsen, 2000; Wong, 2026). For our group's login/register redesign, this reinforces that leaning into Jakob's Law, rather than trying to reinvent the login flow, is likely to serve the client's goal of a generic, flexible system that new and returning users can pick up without friction.

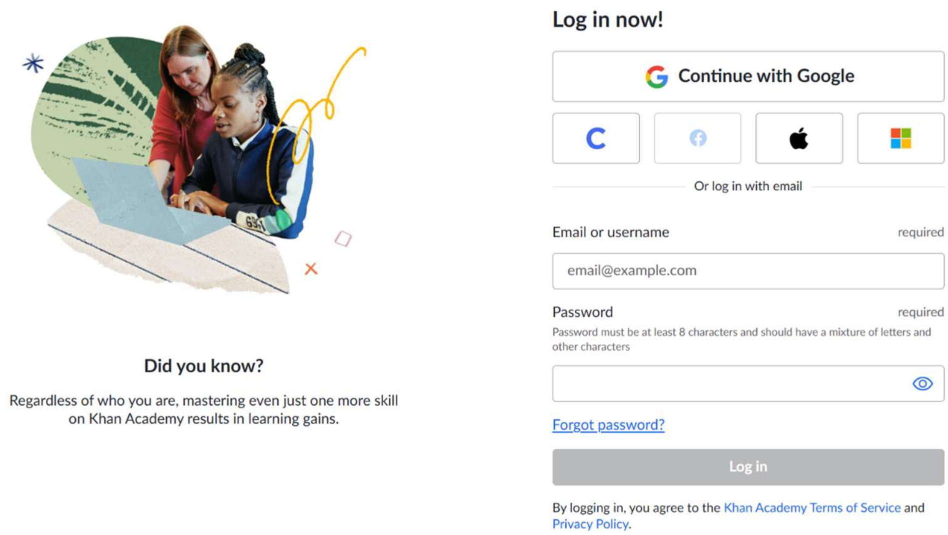
8. Evidence / Appendix

Screenshots of Khan Academy's landing, login and about us pages are included below:

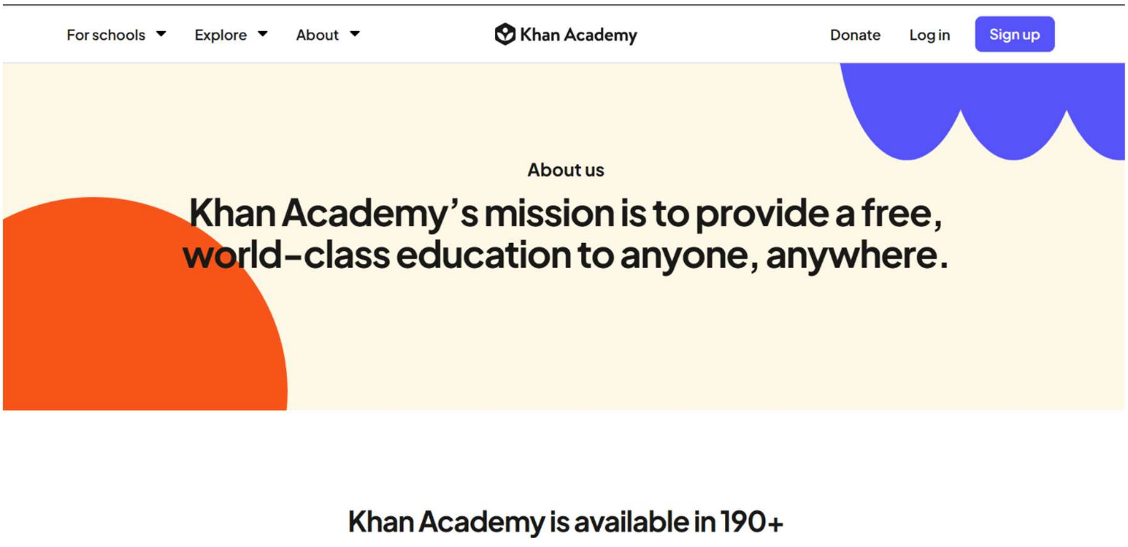
Landing page:



Login page:



About Us page:



Raw UEQ form responses:
https://docs.google.com/forms/d/1KXz91nZ61iE9dcd8DLpfYVc1gJWWnZmoWsC29i43TfA/edit

References

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